

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience supporting fee earners across international arbitration and real estate disputes at BCLP, and currently advising clients at Citizens Advice. Experienced in maintaining case files and electronic document management systems, preparing hearing bundles and court materials, tracking deadlines across multiple concurrent matters, drafting correspondence, and communicating clearly with clients on procedural and administrative matters. Comfortable managing high volumes of confidential documents with accuracy and discretion in a fast-moving legal environment.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural law, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democratic governance) — 75%
- Dissertation: development of GDPR across jurisdictions — mark 55

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Maintained structured electronic case files in iManage and monitored procedural deadlines across a complex investment arbitration
- Coordinated documents and tracked outstanding actions as the team approached a significant submission deadline, becoming the sole junior supporting the team at that stage
- Reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions; drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Handled court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, and deadline tracking across several concurrent matters
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents with competing deadlines; maintained matter records via iManage
- Prepared client notes and cost comparisons; conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold and landlord and tenant issues

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead**July 2026 – Present****Legal Adviser**

- Manages matters from instruction to conclusion: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Interviews clients across welfare, housing, employment, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements and establishes chronologies
- Communicates clearly with clients on procedural requirements and next steps, translating complex rules into practical guidance
- Assesses eligibility against statutory criteria, identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points of law

Q-Legal · London**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet a fixed deadline; maintained clear records throughout
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's data and adtech

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; flagged contractual risks and provisions requiring legal input
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border transfer requirements
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: iManage; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; legal research databases; document review; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across concurrent matters, confidential document management